

How to Trace an IP Address

Received: from mail pickup service by hotmail.com

Thu, 26 Jul 2001 18:43:43 -0700

Received: from **64.168.6.152** by lw10fd.law10.hotr

Fr
X-Orig
From: "

Search results for: 64.168.6.152

Pac Bell Internet Services PBI-NET-8 ([NET-64-160-0-0-1](#))

[64.160.0.0](#) - [64.175.255.255](#)

Search Group Inc SBCIS-1001215-164111 ([NET-64-168-6-128-1](#))

[64.168.6.128](#) - [64.168.6.191](#)

IP Address Tracing

- Goals
 - Determine to whom the IP address is assigned.
 - Usually a business of some sort.
 - Often an Internet Service Provider (ISP) in the case of email.
 - Contact the entity it is assigned to.
 - From their records, determine the identity of the person using that address at the date and time in question.

IP Address Tracing

- IP addresses are allocated to organizations and people by Regional Internet Registries (RIRs).
- Currently, there are 5 RIRs responsible for the administration and registration of IP addresses for the entire global Internet.
 - Each RIR performs this task for different geographical areas.

Investigative Tools

- **There are 5 Regional Internet Registries**
 - **AfriNIC:** www.afrinic.net
 - **Service Region:** Status in progress
 - **APNIC:** www.apnic.net
 - **Service Region:** Asia and Pacific region
 - **ARIN:** www.arin.net
 - **Service Region:** North America, Africa south of the equator, and portions of the Caribbean
 - **LACNIC:** www.lacnic.org
 - **Service Region:** Latin America and portions of the Caribbean

Investigative Tools

- There are 5 Regional Internet Registries (continued)
 - **RIPE NCC:** www.ripe.net/cgi-bin/whois
 - **Service Region:** Europe, Parts of Asia, Africa north of the equator, and the Middle East

IP Address Tracing

- Few individuals can meet the requirements of RIRs to receive IP addresses directly from them.
- RIRs typically allocate blocks of IP addresses to ISPs.
- ISPs, in turn, assign IP addresses to end users (a hierarchical approach):
 - Home users
 - Most businesses

IP Address Tracing

- Each RIR maintains a public database that identifies the organizations that have received address allocations and assignments.
 - Most often they are ISPs and large corporations.
 - Organizations can then sub-delegate blocks of their IP addresses to other organizations.
 - This information is also entered into the RIR databases.

IP Address Tracing

- Very rarely are individuals personally identifiable by their IP address.
 - The identity of a typical home user is not recorded into the database.
 - Only information regarding entities and individuals that administrate addresses are identified.
 - To identify an individual, the organization responsible for the IP address will need to be contacted.
 - User activity and IP address assignment logs.
 - Dynamic IP assignment and NAT issues.

IP Address Tracing

- Access to the RIR databases is provided through the WHOIS service.
 - Can search for point-of-contact and registration information based on an IP address.
- Easiest when done through one of the RIR web sites.
 - Some specialized software and command line utilities available to do searches.
 - Accuracy is best assured when searches are done through the web site.

IP Address Tracing

- Which RIR database to start searching first is not that important.
- The ARIN database is a good place to start for investigators in North America.
 - It will report which database contains the record if it does not belong to ARIN.
 - <http://www.arin.net>



IP Address Tracing

- Example of ARIN referring to the RIPE database for information about a particular IP address.

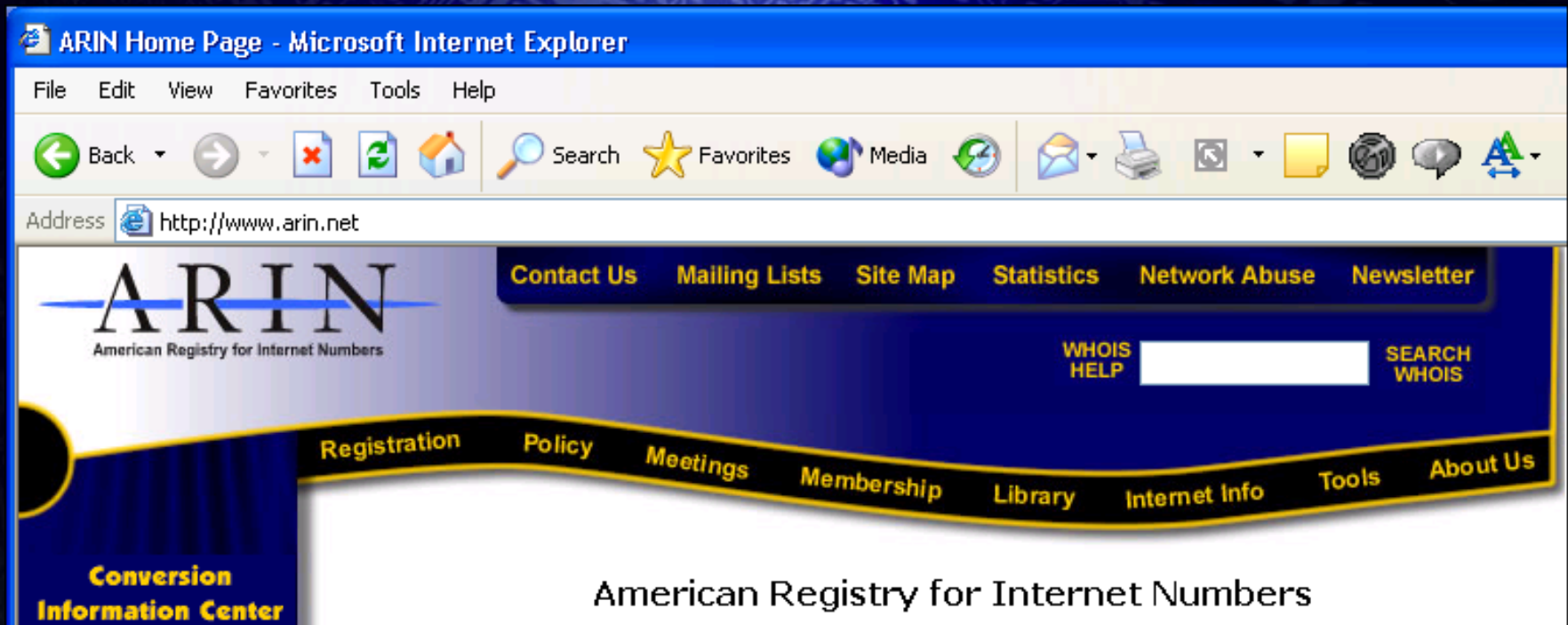
Search results for: 195.44.37.5

OrgName: RIPE Network Coordination Centre
OrgID: [RIPE](#)
Address: Singel 258
Address: 1016 AB
City: Amsterdam
StateProv:
PostalCode:
Country: NL

ReferralServer: whois://whois.ripe.net:43

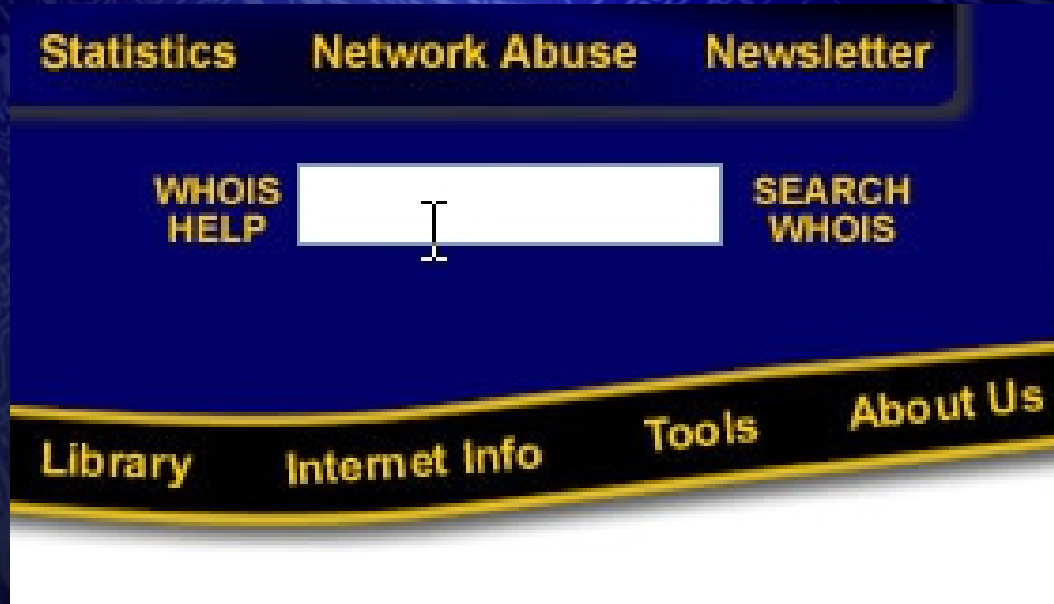
IP Address Tracing

- Step 1: Go to the ARIN web site
 - <http://www.arin.net>



IP Address Tracing

- **Step 2: Enter the IP address in the “SEARCH WHOIS” box and then click on the “SEARCH WHOIS” text.**



The screenshot displays the SEARCH WHOIS web interface. At the top, there are three navigation links: "Statistics", "Network Abuse", and "Newsletter". Below these, on the left, is a link for "WHOIS HELP". In the center is a white search input box with a vertical cursor. To the right of the input box is the text "SEARCH WHOIS". At the bottom of the interface, there is a dark blue banner with four links: "Library", "Internet Info", "Tools", and "About Us".

IP Address Tracing

- Step 3: Locate the point-of-contact information.
 - The information returned may be in a hierarchical tree, or
 - May show the name of the organization without contact information.
 - Either of these two results require additional steps.

IP Address Tracing

- Hierarchical Tree
 - The organization on the bottom of the tree has obtained its IP address from the organization listed above it.

Search results for: 64.168.6.152

The
ISP
for

← Pac Bell Internet Services PBI-NET-8 ([NET-64-160-0-0-1](#))

[64.160.0.0](#) - [64.175.255.255](#)

→ Search Group Inc SBCIS-1001215-164111 ([NET-64-168-6-128-1](#))

[64.168.6.128](#) - [64.168.6.191](#)

IP Address Tracing

- Hierarchical Tree
 - The organization on the bottom of the tree is the one to contact for information identifying the user of the IP address that you searched for.

Search results for: 64.168.6.152

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IP Address Tracing

- Hierarchical Tree
 - Click on the link to the right of the organization's name that begins with "NET" (the Net Handle link).

Search results for: 64.168.6.152

The
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for

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IP Address Tracing

- Hierarchical Tree
 - The next screen will show the organization's point-of-contact information.
 - Phone numbers or web sites for the organizations listed can often be found with popular Internet search sites such as www.google.com and www.yellowpages.com

Search results for: ! NET-64-168-6-128-1

```
CustName:    Search Group Inc
Address:     7311 Greenhaven Drive, Suite #145
City:        Sacramento
StateProv:   CA
PostalCode:  95831
Country:     US
RegDate:     2000-12-16
Updated:     2000-12-16
```


IP Address Tracing

- Organization's Name, but no contact info.
 - Look for the field "OrgID:" and click on the link next to it.

Search results for: 172.134.41.134

OrgName:	America Online
OrgID:	AOL
Address:	22000 AOL Way
City:	Dulles
StateProv:	VA
PostalCode:	20166
Country:	US

IP Address Tracing

- Organization's Name, but no contact info.
 - The information that appears will be the point-of-contact information.

Search results for: O ! AOL

```
OrgName:      America Online
OrgID:        AOL
Address:      22000 AOL Way
City:         Dulles
StateProv:    VA
PostalCode:   20166
Country:      US
Comment:
RegDate:      1992-04-01
Updated:      2003-06-19

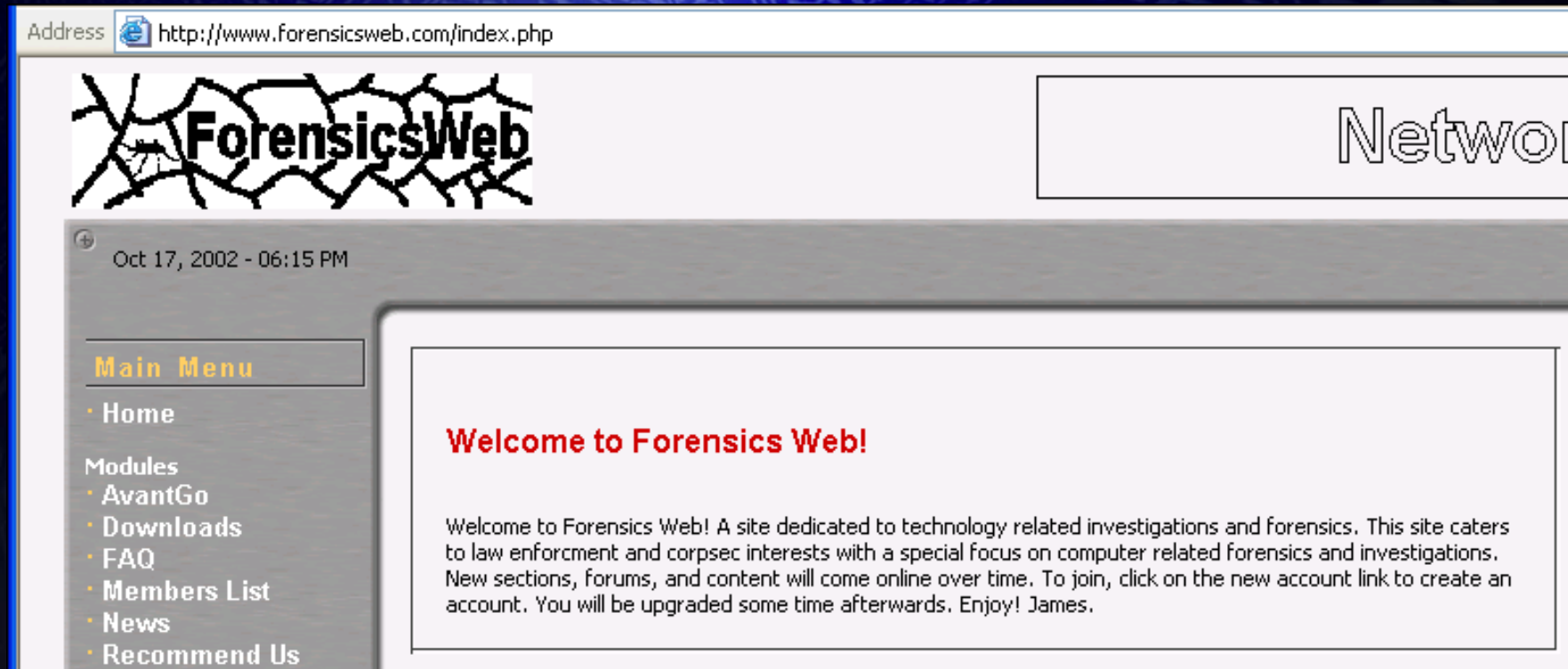
AbuseHandle:  AOL382-ARIN
AbuseName:    Abuse
AbusePhone:   +1-703-265-4670
AbuseEmail:   abuse@aol.net
```


IP Address Tracing

- Obtain additional point-of-contact information from this web site:
<http://www.forensicsweb.com>
 - This site focuses on investigative and computer forensic issues for law enforcement and corporate security personnel.
 - This site provides a list of legal contacts for organizations with which law enforcement is likely to interact.
 - Only the common organizations.

IP Address Tracing

- Viewing and obtaining the contact list.
- Go to <http://www.forensicsweb.com>



IP Address Tracing

- Click on the “Downloads” link.



IP Address Tracing

- In the center of the screen, click on the “ISP Contacts List” link.

Forensics Web -- Downloads

[[New](#) | [Popular](#) | [Top Rated](#)]

Main download categories

- **CFID** (3)
Files for the Computer Forensics Investigators Digest listserv.
[ISP Contacts List](#)

There are 3 Downloads and 2 categories in the database.

IP Address Tracing

- Choose one of the available formats
 - HTML
 - PDF
 - Word
- Click on the red link for it (the one with the star next to it).

Main / CFID / ISP Contacts List

Sort downloads by: Title (A\D) Date (A\D) Rating (A\D) Popularity (A\D)
Resources currently sorted by: Title (A-Z)

ISP Contacts List - HTML Format ★

Description: This list contains a variety of ISPs and similar information serving subpoenae, court orders, and search warrants. Updates, corrections, and existing entries are made to simplify addition. An additional resource is the copyright matters and can be found at <http://www.loc.gov/copyright/online>

Version: Filesize: 0 bytes

Added on: 29-Mar-2002 Downloads: 1694

[Homepage](#) | [Details](#)

ISP Contacts List - PDF Format ★

Description: This list contains a variety of ISPs and similar information serving subpoenae, court orders, and search warrants. Updates, corrections, and existing entries are made to simplify addition. An additional resource is the copyright matters and can be found at <http://www.loc.gov/copyright/online>

Version: Filesize: 0 bytes

Added on: 29-Mar-2002 Downloads: 953

[Homepage](#) | [Details](#)

ISP Contacts List - Word Format ★

Description: This list contains a variety of ISPs and similar information serving subpoenae, court orders, and search warrants. Updates, corrections, and existing entries are made to simplify addition. An additional resource is the copyright matters and can be found at <http://www.loc.gov/copyright/online>

Version: Filesize: 0 bytes

Added on: 29-Mar-2002 Downloads: 937

[Homepage](#) | [Details](#)

IP Address Tracing

- This is what the HTML format looks like.
(The list is in alphabetical order.)

Online Services List

August 2002 Edition

<http://www.forensicsw>

Last Updated

Maintained by James Nerlinger, Jr. --> isplist@info

If you have any additions, please put the information

Please note that all updates come from officers in the

please contact the list maintainer at isplist@info

Beginning with the 08/01/2000 edition, last update

@HOME NETWORK (09/00)

SEE EXCITE, INC BELOW

ABOVENET (10/01)

See Metromedia Fiber Network

ADELPHIA COMMUNICATIONS (09/00)

Contact Name Legal Department, Attention Leslie Brown

Online Service Adelphia Communications (Adelphia.Net)

Online Service Address Main at Water, Coudersport, PA 16915 ATTN: LEGAL DEPARTMENT

Voice Number 814-274-9830

Fax Number 814-274-7782

AIRTOUCH (see also Verizon Wireless) (12/01)